

— EDITION 37

What I check first when a deploy fails, in order

When something I shipped falls over on boot, I no longer start with the code. I work a fixed order, and the model is last on it.

A 8-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 08

| Read the error first.

Properly, not the skim. The machine usually tells you the answer in plain language, and we talk over it with our own assumptions.

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| 1. Environment.

Is the runtime what I think it is. Right versions, right packages, right config actually loaded. Most failures live here, before anything clever runs.

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| 2. Network.

Can the box reach what it needs. Outbound access, DNS, the right ports open. A correct call to an unreachable host still fails.

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3. Drivers and dependencies.

Is the thing that connects to the database or service installed, and matched to the version actually in use. Mismatches fail in confusing ways.

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| 4. Addressing.

IPv4 versus IPv6, the right host, the right region. Boring, and it bites more often than anyone admits.

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| 5. The payload.

Did the other side return what I assumed. A 200 with an empty body is not success. Check the contents, not just the status code.

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| 6. Privileges.

Can the process do the specific action, not just start. Permission to run is not permission to finish the job.

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| The model is last.

By the time I reach it, it is almost never the model. Check the boring layers before you blame the clever one.

— THE TAKEAWAY

That is the order, every **time.**

What is the first thing you check when a deploy dies? Follow Joseph Bankole for more from shipping AI into real stacks.

◆ Joseph Bankole